

LeverageAI Partners — Visual Identity & Token Spec

Appends PRD v1.0 **Purpose** Prevent generic output from Claude Code

Pass this entire section at the start of every Claude Code session

1. Aesthetic direction

Direction

Refined dark-navy minimal. Think boutique IT firm meets operator's desk — serious without being corporate, confident without being flashy.

Mood

Trustworthy, precise, peer-to-peer. A prospect should feel like they found an expert, not a vendor.

Not

No purple gradients. No glowing orbs. No "AI startup" dark neon aesthetics. No stock robot imagery.

Reference feel

Linear.app + a well-designed consulting firm. Clean grid. Purposeful whitespace. Typography does the heavy lifting.

2. Color tokens

Define these as CSS custom properties in :root and reference them everywhere — never hardcode hex values in components.

- color-bg

#0D1B2A

— page background, dark navy
- color-surface

#1E2D3D

— card and section surfaces
- color-surface-raised

#253547

— hover states, elevated cards
- color-text-primary

#E8EDF2

— headlines, body
- color-text-secondary

#8A9BB0

— captions, labels, subtext
- color-accent

#2D6BE4

— primary CTA buttons, links, active states
- color-accent-green

#1BA87E

— secondary accent, step numbers, success indicators
- color-border

rgba(255,255,255,0.08)

— card borders, dividers

--color-border-strong rgba(255,255,255,0.15) — hover borders, emphasized dividers

bg #0D1B2A

surface #1E2D3D

accent #2D6BE4

green #1BA87E

muted #8A9BB0

text #E8EDF2

Accent blue is used sparingly — CTA buttons, links, and one highlight element per section. Never use it as a background for large areas. Green is for "proof" moments: step numbers, checkmarks, ROI callouts.

3. Typography

Display font

DM Serif Display — Google Fonts. Used for hero headline only. Adds editorial weight without feeling stuffy.

Body font

IBM Plex Sans — Google Fonts. Clean, technical, slightly utilitarian. Perfect for a firm that does IT work.

Mono font IBM Plex Mono — for code snippets, tool names, small data labels

Import

```
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?
family=DM+Serif+Display&family=IBM+Plex+Sans:wght@400;500&family=IBM+Plex+Mono:wght@400&display=swap')
```

Hero headline	<i>DM Serif Display · 56–72px · italic · lh 1.1</i>
Section heading	IBM Plex Sans · 32–40px · weight 500 · lh 1.2
Subheading	IBM Plex Sans · 20px · weight 500 · lh 1.4
Body text	IBM Plex Sans · 16–17px · weight 400 · lh 1.75
Label / caption	IBM PLEX SANS · 11–12PX · 500 · UPPERCASE · LS 0.08EM
CTA button	IBM Plex Sans · 15px · weight 500 · no uppercase

The hero headline in DM Serif Display italic is the one moment of personality. Everything else is IBM Plex Sans — tight, clean, confident. Never mix in a third font family.

4. Spacing system

Use a 4px base grid. All spacing values are multiples of 4.

Extra tight — icon gaps, badge padding

4px · --space-1

Tight — between label and value	8px · --space-2
Default — card internal padding, list gaps	16px · --space-4
Comfortable — between card elements	24px · --space-6
Section — between content blocks	40px · --space-10
Generous — between page sections	80–120px · --space-section

Section padding-top and padding-bottom should be at least 80px on desktop, 48px on mobile. Don't compress vertical rhythm — the whitespace is what makes the design feel premium.

5. Component rules

Border radius Cards: 12px . Buttons: 8px . Badges/pills: 4px . Never fully round large elements.

Cards

Background --color-surface . Border 1px solid var(--color-border) . Padding 24px 28px . On hover: border → --color-border-strong , bg → --color-surface-raised .

Primary button

Bg --color-accent , text white, padding 14px 28px , radius 8px , weight 500. Hover: brightness 110%. No border.

Ghost button

Transparent bg, 1px solid --color-border-strong , text --color-text-primary . Hover: bg --color-surface .

Nav

Transparent on scroll top. Blurred bg (backdrop-filter: blur(12px) + background: rgba(13,27,42,0.85)) when scrolled. No box shadow — just the blur.

Dividers 1px solid var(--color-border) . Never use hr with default styling.

Step numbers

Circle, 32px, bg rgba(27,168,126,0.15) , text --color-accent-green , font IBM Plex Mono, weight 400.

Section labels

All-caps, 11px, letter-spacing 0.1em, color --color-accent or --color-accent-green . Used above section headings as an eyebrow.

6. Layout grid

Max width 1100px centered. Side padding: 24px mobile, 48px tablet, 80px desktop.

Columns

12-column grid. Most content sections use 8-of-12 centered. Full-width sections break the grid intentionally.

Hero layout

Headline left-aligned (not centered). Max-width 700px . CTA button inline-left below subhead. This breaks the "centered hero" default — more editorial, less template.

How it works

3-column horizontal on desktop, stacked on mobile. Each step: number → title → 2-line description. No heavy cards — just the content with a thin left border accent.

Services section

3-column card grid. Intentionally smaller and quieter than the how-it-works section. Label text reads "Where clients go next" — not "Our Services".

7. Motion & animation

Page load

Staggered fade-up on hero: headline → subhead → CTA. Each element: opacity 0 → 1 , translateY(16px) → 0 , duration 0.6s ease-out , stagger 120ms .

Scroll reveal

Sections fade in as they enter viewport. Use IntersectionObserver with threshold 0.15 . Same fade-up as page load. One animation per element — no bouncing.

Hover states

All transitions: 150ms ease . Cards lift slightly (border brightens, bg lightens). Button hover: brightness only, no scale.

Never use

Parallax, looping background animations, typewriter effects, spinning icons, or anything that moves without user intent.

8. Do / don't

- ✗ Inter, Roboto, or system-ui as the primary font
- ✓ DM Serif Display for hero, IBM Plex Sans everywhere else
- ✗ Purple gradients, glowing rings, neon accents
- ✓ Solid navy bg, minimal blue accent used twice per section max
- ✗ Centered hero headline like every SaaS landing page
- ✓ Left-aligned headline, editorial feel, max-width constrained
- ✗ Hardcoded hex values in component files

- ✓ All colors via CSS variables defined in `:root`
- ✗ 8+ sections all styled with equal visual weight
- ✓ Hero and CTA get full visual weight. Services section is intentionally quiet.

9. Claude Code prompt to paste

Paste this at the very start of your Claude Code session, before any other instructions:

Before writing any code, establish a design system in a `tokens.css` file (or a `globals.css` if using Next.js) with the following CSS custom properties:

Colors: `--color-bg: #0D1B2A, --color-surface: #1E2D3D, --color-surface-raised: #253547, --color-text-primary: #E8EDF2, --color-text-secondary: #8A9BB0, --color-accent: #2D6BE4, --color-accent-green: #1BA87E, --color-border: rgba(255,255,255,0.08), --color-border-strong: rgba(255,255,255,0.15)`

Typography: Import DM Serif Display and IBM Plex Sans + IBM Plex Mono from Google Fonts. Hero headline uses DM Serif Display italic. All other text uses IBM Plex Sans. Never use Inter, Roboto, or system-ui.

Spacing: 4px base grid. Use 4, 8, 16, 24, 40, 80px as your spacing scale. Section vertical padding minimum 80px desktop / 48px mobile.

Components: Cards use 12px radius, 1px border using `--color-border`, bg `--color-surface`, padding 24px 28px. Primary button uses `--color-accent` bg, 8px radius, 14px 28px padding, weight 500. Nav is transparent on load, backdrop-blur with `rgba(13,27,42,0.85)` when scrolled.

Layout: Max-width 1100px centered. Hero headline is LEFT-aligned, not centered. Font size 56–72px, DM Serif Display italic.

Motion: Hero elements fade-up on load with 120ms stagger. Scroll sections use IntersectionObserver fade-up. All hover transitions 150ms ease. No parallax, no looping animations.

Aesthetic: Dark navy minimal. No purple gradients. No neon. No generic AI startup aesthetics. Looks like a boutique technical consultancy.